

```
/* Define basic paragraph style */
p {
color:#000;
line-height:150%
}

/* Highlight class to pick out key words or phrases */
.highlight {
background-color:#FF0;
}
```

5.2 Image formats for backgrounds

Three main formats are acceptable, namely GIF, JPEG, and PNG files. The latter is used considerably less than the other two, but it is still a very useful type when needed.

5.2.1 GIF

The GIF (pronounced “gif” or “jif” by some) format keeps the size of the file as small as possible. The GIF was created when colour displays were limited to 256 colours and the internet was slow. Instead of describing one pixel at a time in terms of its colour, a gif describes the boundaries of an area and the single colour within that area following the concept of vector graphics. In cases where there are large areas of certain colours, the file size is smaller.

The best thing about GIFs is that they can carry a certain amount of transparency, which can be invaluable for web design. Imagine that you wish to have a small arrow icon appear in every heading, but that headings appear on many different background colours. This is where the transparent GIF will come in handy. As long as the GIF is saved with transparency, it will allow the background colour to come through. Regrettably, transparent GIFs are not perfect, and rounded or jagged edges will be saved with a few non transparent pixels around them. While transparent GIFs really extend the limits of image use on the Web, they do have limitations, especially where transparent gradients are concerned. A more complex solution to a transparent image is the “PNG”.

5.2.2 JPEG

The familiar image format JPEGs are incredibly flexible, but an image saved as a JPEG (pronounced “jay-peg”) isn’t analysed for colour in the